

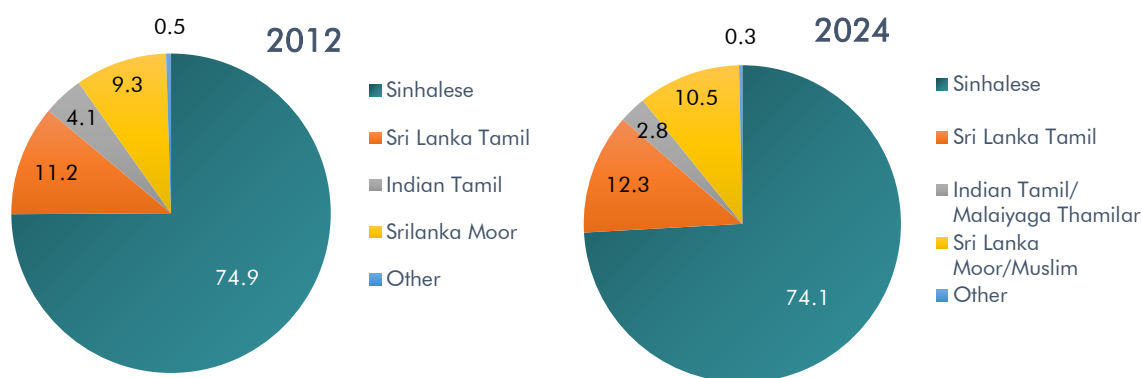


Figure 6.1.9 : Percentage Distribution of Population by Ethnic group, 2012 and 2024

Table 6.1.9 presents the percentage distribution of the population by ethnic group and province of usual residence during the census period.

Table 6.1.9 : Percentage Distribution of the Population by Ethnic Group and Province, 2024

Province	Total	Ethnic group (%)									
		Sinhalese	Sri Lanka Tamil	Indian Tamil/ Malaiyaga Thamilar	Sri Lanka Moor/Muslim	Burgher	Malay	Sri Lanka Chetty	Bharatha	Veddass	Other
Sri Lanka	100.0	74.1	12.3	2.8	10.5	0.2	0.1	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0
Western	100.0	83.6	6.3	0.5	8.9	0.3	0.3	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.1
Central	100.0	65.8	8.3	15.0	10.7	0.1	0.1	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0
Southern	100.0	94.8	1.2	0.4	3.4	0.0	0.2	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0
Northern	100.0	3.2	91.5	0.3	5.0	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0
Eastern	100.0	22.1	38.1	0.1	39.5	0.3	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.1	0.0
North Western	100.0	84.8	2.7	0.1	12.2	0.1	0.1	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0
North Central	100.0	90.5	0.9	0.0	8.5	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.1
Uva	100.0	81.4	6.9	6.9	4.6	0.1	0.1	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0
Sabaragamuwa	100.0	86.5	6.5	2.2	4.8	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0

According to the data, the Sinhalese ethnic group reports a higher percentage in the Southern (94.8%), North Central (90.5%), Sabaragamuwa (86.5%), North Western (84.8%), and Western (83.6%) provinces. The Northern Province is predominantly inhabited by the Sri Lanka Tamil ethnic group, which accounts for 91.5 percent of its population. A significant distribution of Sri Lanka Tamils is also observed in the Eastern (38.1%) and Central (8.3%) provinces. The Indian Tamil/Malaiyaga Thamilar ethnic group is concentrated in the Central Province (15%), with notable presence in the Uva (6.9%) and Sabaragamuwa (2.2%) provinces. The Sri Lanka Moor/Muslim ethnic group is reported as the largest ethnic group in the Eastern Province (39.5%), while also maintaining a significant presence in the North Western (12.2%), Central (10.7%), and Western (8.9%) provinces. The distribution of Burgher, Malay, Sri Lanka Chetty, Bharatha, Veddass, and other ethnic groups totally remains below 0.4 percent across all provinces except Western province.

Table 6.1.10 illustrates the distribution of the population by ethnic group as reported in censuses from 1911 to 2024.